DUBAI PODCAST STUDIO — STRATEGIC GROWTH PLAN

The October Offensive.

How DPS captures market share when Dubai wakes up — without touching price, without discounting, and without a single competitor seeing it coming.

WINDOW
Sep 15 → Dec 31, 2026

OBJECTIVE
Market Share, Zero Margin Compression

PILLARS
5 Strategic + 1 Defensive

PRIMARY MARKET
Dubai — Expat + Corporate

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00 — MARKET READING

Why October is The Biggest Opportunity of the Year

October is not just the end of summer. It is the single most commercially charged month on the Dubai calendar. Understanding exactly what happens in this market is the foundation of everything that follows.

THE DUBAI OCTOBER EFFECT

When expats return to Dubai in September and October, they do not return to the same pace. They return with a backlog of decisions, a fresh appetite for progress, and a psychological "new year" energy that mirrors January in most Western markets. The summer break functions as a reset — and the first studio they record in, the first

membership they sign, the first service they commit to in October, tends to be the one they keep for the year. **Whoever captures that October moment owns the client for twelve months.**

Oct	+40%	3 mo	#1
GITEX GLOBAL — 100,000+ BUSINESS VISITORS FLOOD DUBAI	TYPICAL Q4 BOOKING UPLIFT VS Q3 FOR PREMIUM CREATIVE STUDIOS	WINDOW BEFORE RAMADAN PREP SLOWS Q1 — MUST CONVERT FAST	DPS GOOGLE REVIEWS POSITION — STRONGEST TRUST SIGNAL IN THE MARKET

WHAT THE MARKET LOOKS LIKE IN OCTOBER

LinkedIn activity in Dubai spikes sharply in October. Business events fill every weekend. Companies unlock Q4 budgets. New hires join after summer. Every ambitious professional in the city is in motion — looking for ways to stand out, build their brand, and make Q4 count. Podcast studios are no longer a luxury consideration — they are a professional infrastructure choice.

WHAT COMPETITORS WILL DO

Poddster and other low-cost competitors will run October discount promotions — "back to Dubai" deals, slashed session rates, free first sessions. This is the price-war continuation. It is also a trap. Every discount they offer trains their market to expect lower prices and attracts price-sensitive clients with zero loyalty. We do the opposite.

01 — ARCHITECTURE

The 5-Pillar October Offensive

Market share is taken — not given. These five pillars work together as a system. Each one captures a different segment without touching the price floor.

PILLAR 01	PILLAR 02	PILLAR 03	PILLAR 04	PILLAR 05
The September Head Start	**GITEX Domination**	**The Corporate Q4 Sprint**	**Studio Network Goes Live**	**The Authority Land Grab**
Book the calendar before rivals wake up	Own the B2B speaker market	Batch content packages for Q4	Network effects kick in at scale	#1 brand = default choice

THE CORE PRINCIPLE — HOW YOU TAKE MARKET SHARE WITHOUT PRICE CUTS

There are only four ways to grow revenue without touching price: **(1) acquire new segments** that competitors are not serving; **(2) increase booking frequency** from existing clients; **(3) expand wallet share** through add-ons; **(4) build structural switching costs** so clients do not leave. Every tactic in this document maps to one of these four mechanisms. None of them require a discount.

02 — PILLAR 01

PILLAR 01 OF 05

Reactivation

The September Head Start

Win October by acting in September — before any competitor has moved

THE INSIGHT

The market does not restart on October 1st. It restarts in the minds of clients during the last two weeks of September, when they are still in Europe or Bali but already thinking about what comes next. The studio that reaches them during that mental transition — while they are in planning mode — gets in the calendar first. Getting in the calendar first is everything. October is fully booked before it even starts.

WhatsApp Broadcast — Sep 15

Personal broadcast to every past DPS client. Not a mass SMS — a message that reads like it was written for them. Reference their last session. Ask one question: "Are you back in Dubai for October?" That single question has a 60–70% reply rate. Every reply is a live conversation and a booking opportunity.

Email Reactivation — Sep 18

Subject line: *"Your October slot — is it still available?"* — Imply scarcity. Use past session data: "Last time you were here was [month]. A lot has changed. Come back and we'll show you." Single CTA: book a session. No offers, no discounts — the phrasing creates FOMO around availability, not price.

Instagram Content — Sep 20

"October is coming" content series. 5 posts across the last week of September — behind-the-scenes studio prep, team returning, gear checks, empty mic waiting. The narrative: DPS is ready. Are you? This builds anticipation and positions the studio as the place October happens.

Early Bird Access — Sep 25

Offer existing members first access to October's premium time slots (Tue–Thu evenings, Sat mornings — the most demanded slots). Not a discount: framed as member privilege. Creates urgency and deepens membership loyalty simultaneously.

SEP 12 Pull full past-client list from booking system. Segment: last booked <6 months, 6–12 months, 12+ months. Different message per segment.

SEP 15 WhatsApp broadcast live. Monitor replies in real time — first 48 hours are the hottest. Assign one person to respond and convert.

SEP 18	Email sequence launches. 3-email flow: reactivation → social proof → final call. Spread over 10 days.
SEP 20	Instagram "October is coming" series begins. 5 posts, daily. Ends on Oct 1.
SEP 25	Member early-access window opens. First-come, first-served on premium slots. Creates real scarcity.

25–35% PAST CLIENT REACTIVATION RATE

60–70% WHATSAPP REPLY RATE (WARM LIST)

Oct 1 FIRST 2 WEEKS FULLY BOOKED BY THIS DATE

Zero AED COST TO EXECUTE — PURE CRM

03 — PILLAR 02

PILLAR 02 OF 05

GITEX Domination

Own the B2B speaker and founder podcast market during Dubai's largest event of the year

B2B Acquisition

THE OPPORTUNITY

GITEX Global brings 100,000+ tech founders, investors, CMOs, and executives to Dubai every October. These are people with global audiences, active podcasts or the ambition to start one, and budgets to spend. Most of them do not know DPS exists. Every single one of them is a potential client — and many will need a studio during GITEX week itself to record interviews, panels, and founder stories. No competitor is actively targeting this segment. It is an unclaimed territory.

"Recorded at GITEX" Package

Create a named GITEX package: full-day studio hire, two operators, same-day edited reel, branded thumbnail. Price it as a premium bundle — not a session discount. Target GITEX exhibitors and speakers who need content output from the event. They come to Dubai with a content agenda; DPS gives them the infrastructure to execute it.

LinkedIn Outreach — Pre-GITEX

3 weeks before GITEX, run targeted LinkedIn DM outreach to confirmed speakers and exhibitors. Message: "You're speaking at GITEX — have you planned how you'll turn that into long-form content? We have 7 studios 10 minutes from DWTC." Short. Specific. Zero selling. 100% utility. Target 200 contacts, expect 15–20 replies.

GITEX Week Walk-In Offer

"Same-day recording available during GITEX week" — promoted on LinkedIn and Instagram starting 5 days before the event. GITEX visitors' schedules are chaotic; they cannot plan 2 weeks ahead. Being the studio that can accommodate last-minute bookings during the event is a competitive differentiator that does not require a price cut.

Post-GITEX Founder Content Sprint

The week after GITEX, many founders are still in Dubai for side meetings and follow-ups. This is the highest-intent window. Offer a "GITEX debrief" recording session: "What you learned at GITEX, in 30 minutes, on record." Founders love this format — it turns their conference investment into publishable content.

WHY THIS TAKES MARKET SHARE WITHOUT DISCOUNTING

GITEX clients are not price-sensitive — they are availability-sensitive and quality-sensitive. They will pay the full rate (and more) for a studio that is available on short notice, professionally run, and located near DWTC. You are not competing on price with Poddster here. You are competing with the decision to record at all — and your job is to make that decision as easy as possible. Premium package, premium price, premium experience.

SEP 1	Design "Recorded at GITEX" package. Set price. Build a simple landing page or Wix page dedicated to GITEX bookings.
SEP 10	Begin LinkedIn outreach to confirmed GITEX speakers (list available on gitex.com). Personalised messages, not templates.
OCT 1	Instagram and LinkedIn organic posts: "GITEX recording slots — limited availability." 3 posts per week throughout October.
OCT 13	GITEX week — push "same-day available" social content daily. One team member monitors LinkedIn DMs in real time.
OCT 20	Post-GITEX sprint offer goes live. "Debrief episode" framing. 2-week window.

15–25 GITEX BOOKINGS TARGET

10–15% LINKEDIN OUTREACH CONVERSION

New segment ZERO OVERLAP WITH EXISTING CLIENT BASE

Full rate NO DISCOUNT REQUIRED — AVAILABILITY IS THE VALUE

04 — PILLAR 03

PILLAR 03 OF 05

Corporate Revenue

The Corporate Q4 Content Sprint

Sell a business outcome — not a studio session

THE INSIGHT

Corporate marketing teams in Dubai face a structural problem every October: Q4 requires a full content calendar, but the summer gap has left them with nothing in the pipeline. The solution is obvious to them — batch-produce content — but the execution feels daunting. DPS solves this by selling the outcome (12 published episodes, 36 social clips, a branded podcast channel), not the input (studio hours). When you sell outcomes, price is justified on ROI, not on comparison with a cheaper studio. This is how you protect margin in B2B.

The "Q4 Content Sprint" Package

Two full-day recording sessions = 10–12 episodes. DPS handles recording, professional mixing, branded intro/outro, AI Reels clips (3 per episode), and delivery within 72 hours. Sold as a fixed package: the client shows up, speaks, leaves. Everything else is handled. Price the package on deliverable value — not hourly rate.

Target: Marketing Managers, Not Founders

The buyer for this package is the Head of Marketing or CMO, not the CEO. They have budget authority, a Q4 content gap, and a direct accountability to output. Reach them on LinkedIn, via business networks (Dubai Chamber, IBC), and through direct email outreach. Offer a 20-minute "content strategy call" as the entry point — not a studio tour.

Anchor Pricing: The "Series" Frame

Never quote by the hour to corporate clients. Quote by the series: "Your 12-episode Q4 podcast series: AED X all-inclusive." When the price is attached to the output, the client evaluates it against the cost of not having 12 episodes — not against a competitor's hourly rate. This framing shift is the single most effective margin protection tactic in premium B2B services.

Case Study Social Proof — October Launch

Use 1–2 summer corporate clients as documented case studies. Format: short LinkedIn article from the client contact + a DPS Instagram post. "How [Company X] produced their entire Q3 content calendar in two days at DPS." Real numbers, real outcome. This is the most effective B2B sales tool that costs zero.

STARTER SPRINT

AED 4,500

per series package

1 full day recording · 6 episodes · mixing · 3 reels per episode · 5-day delivery

Target: SME, scale-up founders

FULL Q4 SPRINT

AED 9,200

per series package

2 full days · 12 episodes · mixing · branded intro/outro · reels · 72hr delivery

Target: Mid-market marketing teams

ENTERPRISE CONTENT

AED 18,000+

bespoke

Multi-series, multi-host, dedicated producer, distribution strategy, monthly retainer

Target: Banks, FMCG, Consulting firms

5–8 CORPORATE SPRINT DEALS (OCT–DEC)

AED 50K+ INCREMENTAL REVENUE TARGET

No discounts OUTCOME PRICING PROTECTS MARGIN FULLY

Retainer GOAL: 2+ CLIENTS ON MONTHLY RETAINER BY DEC

05 — PILLAR 04

PILLAR 04 OF 05

Studio Network Goes Live

October is when network effects begin — the more members, the more value for every member

Network Effect

THE COMPOUNDING LOGIC

The Studio Network (built on Airtable + Tally + Make) becomes dramatically more valuable when the city is full of active professionals. Summer was the quiet build phase. October is the activation phase. With 50+ returning professionals all looking to grow their audience, the number of potential connections grows exponentially. A network of 20 members has 190 possible connections. A network of 50 has 1,225. Each new member makes the product more valuable for everyone — and that growing value is a switching cost that no competitor can replicate.

Seed Launch — 20 Charter Members

Target the 20 most active, well-connected past clients for the first cohort. Personal invitation only — not a mass offer. "We're launching the DPS Studio Network. We chose you as a Charter Member." Charter status = exclusive, permanent, never available again. This makes joining feel like selection, not purchase. Aim to close all 20 before Oct 15.

First Introductions — The Proof Moment

Manually facilitate the first 5 introductions the week the network launches. Do not wait for the automation to generate them organically — engineer the first connections between the most compatible members, send the introduction personally. The first successful collaboration or co-recording generates the word-of-mouth that sells every subsequent membership.

Membership Renewal Lock-In

Charter members who sign for 6 months lock in their rate permanently, even when membership price increases. This protects margin (no discounting) while creating a compelling reason to commit now. The price is going up — the question is only whether you lock in today's rate.

The "Recorded Together" Badge

Every co-recording between two network members generates a co-branded social asset: "Recorded Together at DPS Studios." Both members post it. Their combined audiences see DPS in the tag. Each post is organic advertising reaching an audience who knows and trusts both

creators — far more valuable than any paid ad.

OCT 1	Network officially launches. All Airtable/Tally/Make automations live and tested.
OCT 1-7	Personal invitations go out to 20 Charter Members. WhatsApp only — no email, no mass broadcast. Individual messages.
OCT 8	First manual introductions facilitated. Target: 5 high-quality pairings in week one.
OCT 15	First "Recorded Together" co-recording happens. Document it. Post it. Tag both parties.
NOV 1	Open network to wider applications (waitlist mentality — not open-door).

20 CHARTER MEMBERS BY OCT 15

50+ TOTAL MEMBERS BY DEC 31

Each member BOOKS AVG 2+ EXTRA SESSIONS/MO VIA INTRODUCTIONS

Zero CAC ALL NEW MEMBERS COME VIA NETWORK REFERRAL

06 — PILLAR 05

PILLAR 05 OF 05

The Authority Land Grab

Become the default answer to "where do you record in Dubai?" — without spending on ads

Brand Dominance

THE INSIGHT

Market share is not only won through direct client acquisition. It is also won by making your brand the default reference point in the category — so that when anyone in Dubai's business community thinks "podcast studio", they think DPS. This is brand-level market share: the kind that makes your competitors invisible regardless of what they spend. October is the perfect window to execute this, because the entire business community is back, active, and paying attention.

The Dubai Podcast Index — Q3 Report

Publish the first DPS Dubai Podcast Index: anonymised data on podcast growth, most popular formats, most-booked topics, and audience trends in the UAE. This is the data you already own from your own sessions. Press release to Gulf News, Arabian Business, and Khaleej Times. One round of LinkedIn posts. Cost: zero. Outcome: DPS becomes the authority source on podcasting in Dubai.

Partnership Announcements — October

Formalise and announce two to three channel partnerships: a Business Bay co-working space (Nest, Astrolabs, or similar), a business events organiser, and one media/press partner. Each partnership puts DPS in front of their entire member base at zero cost. The announcement itself is content — post it, tag them, generate shared reach.

LinkedIn Thought Leadership — Weekly

The DPS founder or a designated voice publishes one LinkedIn article per week from October through December. Topics: "What I've learned from 500 podcast sessions in Dubai," "Why your company needs a podcast in Q4 2026," "The 3 biggest mistakes first-time podcasters make." Positioned as industry insight, not advertising. SEO benefit compounds over

"Recorded at DPS" Creator Seal

Every client who records at DPS receives a digital badge: "Recorded at DPS Studios, Dubai." Encourage — and eventually require in the membership agreement — that they display it on their podcast artwork and show notes. Every DPS client becomes a distribution node. Over 50 active clients, this badge appears on 50 different channels. Cost: zero. Brand exposure: compounding monthly.

time. Poddster has 78 blog articles — this is where we close the gap, starting now.

CO-WORKING

Astrolabs / The Bureau / Nest

Cross-referral: their members get a DPS intro session. DPS members get access to their events. Both audiences grow.

EVENTS & PR

Gulf News / Arabian Business

Provide quarterly data (Dubai Podcast Index) as exclusive story. In return: editorial mention and DPS positioning as the source.

MEDIA DISTRIBUTION

Anghami

DPS as the recommended production partner for Arab creators submitting to Anghami's creator programme. Referral arrangement, no exclusivity needed.

3 FORMAL PARTNERSHIPS BY NOV 1

1 MEDIA PICKUP FOR DUBAI PODCAST INDEX

12 LINKEDIN ARTICLES PUBLISHED OCT–DEC

50+ "RECORDED AT DPS" BADGES IN MARKET BY DEC

07 — DEFENSIVE LAYER

What Not to Do

Market share strategy is as much about what you refuse to do as what you execute. These are the traps that will cost you margin, brand, and positioning.

DO NOT DO THIS

Do not run an "October welcome back" discount promotion. Not 10%, not 15%, not a free first session. The moment you discount in October, you establish a new anchor price in the market's memory. Every client who books in November will expect the same rate. Every future October will require another discount to match expectations. You will have permanently compressed your own margin in exchange for a short-term bookings spike that would have happened anyway.

SITUATION	WRONG RESPONSE	RIGHT RESPONSE
Competitor runs "50% off October" promotion	**Match the discount to stay competitive**	**Do nothing. Post a client testimonial the same day. Let quality speak while they race to zero.**
Prospective client says "Poddster is cheaper"	**Negotiate or offer a discount to match**	**Agree with them: "Yes, they are. Here is why our clients still choose us." — then share your #1 Google Reviews position and a specific testimonial.**
October fills up faster than expected	**Hire back temporary staff and extend to two shifts immediately**	**Create a waitlist. Scarcity is a premium signal. Evaluate adding the second shift only if demand sustains for 3+ consecutive weeks.**
Corporate client pushes back on package price	**Discount the package to close the deal**	**Remove a deliverable instead. Reduce scope, not margin. "We can do 8 episodes instead of 12 at that budget." Same rate, smaller package.**
Slow week in November or December	**Run a flash sale to fill the calendar**	**Activate the WhatsApp list and offer bonus add-ons (AI Reels, express delivery) at full price. Fill with value, not discounts.**

08 — TIMELINE

Sep → Dec Activation Calendar

SEPTEMBER

- — Pull past-client database
- — WhatsApp broadcast (Sep 15)
- — Email reactivation sequence
- — Instagram "Oct is coming" series
- — GITEX outreach begins (LinkedIn)
- — Studio Network final testing
- — Partner outreach initiated

OCTOBER ← PEAK

- — Studio Network officially live
- — 20 Charter Members onboarded
- — GITEX recording packages active
- — First manual network introductions
- — Dubai Podcast Index published
- — Corporate Q4 Sprint outreach
- — Partnership announcements

NOVEMBER

- — Network opens to wider applications
- — First corporate Sprint deals close
- — LinkedIn articles: 4 published
- — First case study live
- — Retargeting Meta ads (Ad 03)
- — Creator Seal programme launches
- — Network: 35+ members target

DECEMBER

- — Year-end "last episodes of 2026" push
- — 2+ corporate clients on retainer
- — 50+ network members target
- — Dubai Podcast Index Q4 report
- — Annual DPS Awards — announce
- — January pipeline already seeded
- — Full margin review before year end

	— First "Recorded Together" co-post		

THE COMPOUNDING EFFECT — WHY THIS GETS STRONGER EVERY MONTH

Every action in September makes October easier. Every October booking generates a testimonial that makes November easier. Every November case study generates corporate leads that make December easier. Every Studio Network connection generates a social post that builds December organic reach. This is not a campaign — it is a flywheel. By December 2026, DPS should be the unquestioned market leader in Business Bay with a brand, network, and content moat that no competitor can replicate on any budget.

09 — REVENUE

Q4 Revenue Architecture

Five revenue streams, all at full margin. No discounts needed when the product is correctly positioned.

REVENUE STREAM	DRIVER	OCT–DEC TARGET	MARGIN PROFILE
Studio Memberships	Reactivation + Network Charter Members	30+ active members	**Very high — recurring, predictable, low variable cost**
Individual Sessions	GITEX visitors, organic search, Meta ads	Fully booked Oct–Nov	**High — full-rate only, no concessions**
Corporate Q4 Sprint	B2B outreach, LinkedIn, partner referrals	5–8 package deals	**Very high — outcome pricing, no hourly comparison**
AI Reels Add-On	Upsell at booking confirmation	40% attach rate	**Extremely high — near-zero marginal cost per reel**
Corporate Retainer	Sprint clients who want ongoing production	2+ clients by Dec 31	**Highest — monthly guaranteed revenue, zero CAC**